



“B-school graduates have a good network of alumni, professors, and mentors, who can be beneficial for the business in building partnerships and hiring exceptional talent”

AMIT GUPTA

CO-FOUNDER, YULU



“They’re trained to approach problems with a structured mindset, complementing the agility and speed of start-ups... Any gaps in practical experience are addressed through our hands-on approach”

SAHIL MATHUR

CHRO, INMOBI GROUP

take ownership and learn on the go through real scenarios,” he says.

B-school graduates bring energy, curiosity, and ambition, focussing more on their potential rather than their initial experience. Mathur adds that nurturing talent and encouraging internal growth helps start-ups strike the right balance. Kumar of Licious highlights that internships and live projects are key to forming sustainable partnerships between start-ups and B-school grads.

THE ‘C’ FACTOR

One area where B-school graduates have a distinct advantage is compensation. According to Yulu’s Gupta, graduates from Tier I B-schools start their careers with a significant head start over their counterparts from other institutions. “This is true for any top college hire across industries, not just start-ups,” he says. Industry experts note that MBA graduates with relevant experience often command higher compensation than non-MBAs, because of specialised skills.

Start-ups compete with established companies by offering competitive compensation packages to attract top talent. Another appealing incentive for B-school graduates is the opportunity to receive Esops, which add significant value to their overall benefits.

And while experience matters, the entrepreneurial mindset is a critical asset in today’s business environment. As companies continue to evolve and adapt to new challenges, the ability to think like an entrepreneur is becoming a defining factor for success at start-ups. **BT**

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are younger, there’s a hunger for growth and higher salaries,” she says. While B-school graduates bring fresh ideas and agility, experienced professionals offer a richness of experience that is equally critical to a company’s success.

Raman adds that large organisations, much like start-ups, are also realising the need to adapt to new-age businesses to avoid becoming obsolete. Many companies are looking to invest in innovative business models, and B-school graduates are often at the forefront of evaluating these opportunities, she adds. “If large organisations continue to operate as they have for the last 20-30

years, they risk perishing. B-school grads are bringing in the kind of thinking that organisations need to stay relevant,” she says.

While there may be certain skill gaps between B-school graduates and industry professionals, most CHROs agree that these can be addressed within the start-up ecosystem. Mathur of InMobi says that his company views the gap between academic learning and real-world application as an opportunity, rather than a challenge. “Any gaps in practical experience are quickly addressed through our hands-on approach, where every team member is encouraged to